

Rig Veda is the oldest Veda. It comprises of 10 Mandals. The 9th Mandal of Rig Veda comprises 114 hymns dedicated to 'Soma.'

3. Boghaz-Koi is important because:

- (a) It was an important trading centre between Central Asia and Tibet
- (b) Inscriptions were found which mentioned the names of Vedic Gods and Goddesses
- (c) Original Texts of the Vedas were composed here
- (d) None of the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Boghaz-Koi inscription (Asia Minor, Turkiye) is important because there is mention of four Vedic Gods, namely Indra, Varuna, Mitra, and Nasatya.

4. Famous Battle of 'Ten Kings' was fought on the bank of the river:

- (a) The Ganges
- (b) Brahmaputra
- (c) Kaveri
- (d) Parushni

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

There is an ancient story mentioned in the Rig Veda called the Dasharajnya or 'Battle of 10 Kings' on the bank of the Parushni River. There lived a descendant of India's eponymous king Bharata, named Sudas. The greatest achievement of Sudas was his thumping victory over a confederacy of ten kings.

5. Gayatri Mantra is found in which book?

- (a) Upanishad
- (b) Bhagwatgita
- (c) Rig Veda
- (d) Yajurveda

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The Gayatri Mantra was first written in Sanskrit in the Rig Veda by the Brahmarshi Vishwamitra. Its meaning is "May the Almighty God illuminate our intellect to lead us along the righteous path."

6. In which phase, the concept of untouchability was put clearly?

- (a) Rigvedic phase
- (b) Later Vedic phase
- (c) Later Gupta phase
- (d) Dharmashastra phase

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The concept of untouchability assumed a definite shape in the early Christian era which was the period known as the era of Dharmashastra in ancient Indian history. During this period, the Brahmanical religion was in ascendance. Various scriptures were being written and the social customs of different types were practised strictly and untouchability was one of them.

7. Which ancient Indian text, composed during the later Vedic period, contains philosophical hymns and discussions on cosmology and ethics?

- (a) Yajurveda
- (b) Upanishads
- (c) Rigveda
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

The Upanishads are a collection of philosophical texts composed during the later Vedic period in ancient India. They explore concepts of cosmology, ethics, and the nature of reality.

The Upanishads are late Vedic and post-Vedic Sanskrit texts that "document the transition from the archaic ritualism of the Veda into new religious ideas and institutions" and the emergence of the central religious concepts of Hinduism. They are the most recent addition to the Vedas, the oldest scriptures of Hinduism, and deal with meditation, philosophy, consciousness, and ontological knowledge.

Buddhism

1. Where did Mahatma Buddha's 'Mahaparinirvana' take place?

- (a) Lumbini
- (b) Bodh Gaya
- (c) Kushi Nagar
- (d) Kapilvastu

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

Mahatma Buddha delivered his first sermon at the site of Deer Park at Sarnath. Later he moved towards Kosala, Kapilavastu, Vaishali and Rajgriha to propagate the teachings of Buddhism. The king of Kosala Prasenjit with his entire family adopted discipleship of Buddha. During his campaign, he reached 'Pava', the capital of Mallas. At Pava, Buddha stayed in the mango grove of Chund, the blacksmith. There Chund provided him a large amount of Sukaramaddava, which resulted in sickness with the flow of blood and violent deadly pains, but Buddha reached Kushinara or Khushi Nagar (Capital of Republic of Malla). Here he abandoned his body in 483 B.C. at the age of 80 years. It is also known as Mahaparinirvana.

2. The ruler of Suvarnabhumi, who founded a Buddhist monastery at Nalanda and requested Devapala through his ambassador to grant, five villages for its maintenance, was:

- (a) Dharanindra
- (b) Sangramadhananjaya
- (c) Balaputradeva
- (d) Chudamanivarmana

(e) None of the above/More than on of the above.

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (c)

Balaputradeva was the ruler of Suvarnabhumi who founded a Buddhist monastery at Nalanda and requested Devapala through his ambassador to grant five villages for its maintenance.

3. At which place did Mahatma Buddha give his first 'Dhammachakkhapavathana'?

- (a) Lumbini (b) Sarnath
(c) Pataliputra (d) Vaishali

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

After his enlightenment in Bodh Gaya, Buddha went to Sarnath, where he delivered his first sermon which is known in Pali as the 'Dhammachakkhapavathana' or "Dharma Chakra Pravartana." Sarnath is one of the four holy places associated with the life of Buddha. Other three important places related to Buddhism are Lumbini (the birthplace of Buddha) Bodh Gaya (the place of enlightenment of Buddha) and Kushi Nagar (place of his death popularly known as Mahaparinirvana in Buddhism).

4. Who got enlightenment in Bodh Gaya?

- (a) Mahavir Swami (b) Gautam Buddha
(c) Smandhar Swami (d) Parshvanath Swami
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Gautam Buddha gave his first sermon at:

- (a) Vaishali (b) Kaushambi
(c) Sarnath (d) Pawapuri

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

6. Which of the following rulers convened the Fourth Buddhist Council in Kashmir?

- (a) Ashoka (b) Ajatashatru
(c) Kanishka (d) Kalashoka
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (c)

The Fourth Buddhist Council was held at Kundalvana, Kashmir under the patronage of Kushan King Kanishka and the president of this council was Vasumitra, with Ashvag-hosa as his deputy president. This council distinctly divided Buddhism into two sects, namely Mahayana and Hinayana.

7. A Buddhist Council during the reign of Kanishka was held at –

- (a) Magadha (b) Pataliputra
(c) Kashmir (d) Rajgriha

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. Where was the third Buddhist Council held?

- (a) Taxila (b) Sarnath
(c) Bodh Gaya (d) Pataliputra

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

The Third Buddhist Council was held during the reign of Ashoka in 247 B.C. at Pataliputra under presidentship of Moggaliputta Tissa.

9. The Third Buddhist Council was presided over by

- (a) Mahakassapa (b) Vasumitra
(c) Ashvaghosha (d) Moggaliputta-Tissa
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Four important events of Buddha's life and thereby related four places are mentioned below.

Match Schedule- I and Schedule- II and select correct answer from the codes given below -

Schedule - I

Schedule - II

A. Birth

1. Sarnath

B. Enlightenment

2. Bodh Gaya

C. First preaching

3. Lumbini

D. Death

4. Kushinagar

Code :

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|--------------------|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 4 | 3 |
| (b) | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |
| (c) | 3 | 2 | 1 | 4 |
| (d) | None of the above. | | | |

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Mahatma Buddha was born in 563 B.C. in Lumbini near Kapilvastu (Nepal). He got enlightenment at Bodh Gaya. Buddha gave his first sermon at Sarnath (Rishipattan) called “Dharma Chakra Pravartana” and died in Kushinagar called “Mahaparinirvana.

11. In Indian art, the construction of ‘Stupa’, ‘Chaitya’ and ‘Vihara’ is related to which of the following?

- (a) Ajivika sect (b) Vaishnava sect
(c) Buddhism (d) Shaiva sect

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

'Stupa', 'Chaitya', and 'Vihara' all are related to Buddhism. Stupa is a dirt burial mound faced with stone. In Buddhism, the earliest stupas contained portions of the Buddha's ashes, and as a result, it began to be associated with the body of the Buddha. Chaitya is a place of worship while Vihara is the dwelling place of monks.

12. Mahabodhi Temple has been built at Bodh Gaya where-

- (a) Gautama Buddha was born
(b) Gautama Buddha received enlightenment
(c) Gautama Buddha gave his first sermon
(d) Gautama Buddha passed away

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

For full six years, Gautam sought a due solution to the sufferings, ultimately he got enlightenment at the age of 35 years at Bodh Gaya under the Pipal tree on a Vaisakh Purnima night. Hence he was called “Buddha.” Mahabodhi temple was built at this site.

13. The ‘Bodhi Vriksh’ in Bodh Gaya belongs to which generation of its family?

- (a) Third (b) Fourth
(c) Fifth (d) Sixth

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

At present, the ‘Bodhi Vriksh’ at the Mahabodhi temple is not the real one, where Mahatma Buddha got enlightenment. According to the Hiuen Tsang, a Chinese traveler, King Shashank destroyed the original tree in the seventh century A.D. The present tree which we see was planted by the orders of Alexander Cunningham and called the fifth generation tree. It is a heritage site and only fallen leaves of this tree are allowed to touch and pick.

14. After the Mahaparinirvana of Lord Buddha, the first Buddhist council was held at:

- (a) Rajgriha (Rajgir) (b) Gaya
(c) Pataliputra (d) Vaishali
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

The first Buddhist council was held just after the death (Mahaparinirvana) of Lord Buddha during the tenure of Magadh king Ajatashatru in the Sattapanni caves of Rajgriha (Rajgir).

15. Where was the first Buddhist Council convened?

- (a) Pataliputra (b) Rajagriha
(c) Amaravati (d) Kanganhalli
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

The first Buddhist Mahasabha/Sangeet was organised in the Sattapanni cave of Rajagriha immediately after the death of Mahatma Buddha. At that time Ajatashatru was the ruler of Magadha.

16. Tripitakas are the sacred books of the:

- (a) Jains (b) Hindus
(c) Parsees (d) Buddhists
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (d)

Tripitaka is the most important holy book of Buddhism. It is divided into three parts - Sutta Pitaka – which consists of sermons and teachings of Buddha, Vinaya Pitaka – a collection of rules governing the Sanghas and Monks and Abhidhamma Pitaka - which deals with the philosophy of Buddhism.

17. Where is the highest in the world ‘Vishwa Shanti Stupa’ located in Bihar –

- (a) Vaishali (b) Nalanda
(c) Rajgir (d) Patna

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

The Vishwa Shanti Stupa or the World Peace Pagoda (height about 400 metres) situated on the hills of Rajgir in Bihar is the highest Vishwa Shanti Stupa in the world.

18. Barabudur is the most wonderful Stupa in the world and its images and sculptures are the finest examples of

- (a) Indo-Tibetan Art (b) Indo-Cambodian Art

- (c) Indo-Champan Art (d) Indo-Javanese Art
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (d)

The Barabudur (Borobudur) Stupa is located on the Island of Java in Indonesia. Its sculptures are the finest example of Indo-Javanese Art. The construction of this stupa took place in the about 8th and 9th century.

19. Gautam Buddha was elevated to the position of God during the period of:

- (a) Ashoka
(b) Kanishka
(c) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
(d) Harsha

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

The fourth council held during the reign of Kanishka divided Buddhism into two sects, namely Hinayana and Mahayana. In Mahayana, Gautam Buddha was treated as God and they started worshipping Buddha through idols. Hence, Gautam Buddha was elevated to the position of God during the period of Kanishka.

20. The oldest sculpture of Buddha is made in which style?

- (a) Gandhara Style (b) Mathura Style
(c) Mauryan Style (d) Gupta Style
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans (e)

During the Kushana period various statues of Buddha and Bodhisattva (both in standing and sitting position) were made in Mathura and Gandhara style. As per V.S. Agrawal, Buddha statues were first made in Mathura only. As per Huein Tsang first Buddha statue was made in Kaushambi but various other historians give credit to Gandhara style for the first statue of Buddha. Hence, it cannot be said conclusively where the first statue of Buddha was made.

21. Which among the following state 'Odantipur' Education Centre was situated?

- (a) Bengal (b) Bihar
(c) Gujarat (d) Tamil Nadu
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Odantipur (also called Uddandapura) was a prominent educational centre of ancient times. It was situated in Magadha, now Bihar, India. It was established by the Pala emperor Gopala first.

22. Nalanda University was founded during the dynasty of

- (a) Maurya (b) Kushan
(c) Gupta (d) Pala

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Nalanda was a large Buddhist monastery in the ancient kingdom of Magadha (modern-day Bihar) in India. Historians often described Nalanda as a University. Nalanda flourished under the Gupta Empire and was famous for Buddhist religious philosophy.

23. Why was Nalanda University famous in the world?

- (a) Medical Science
(b) Philosophy
(c) Buddhist Religious Philosophy
(d) Chemical Science

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. Who was the founder of Nalanda University?

- (a) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
(b) Kumargupta
(c) Dharmapala
(d) Pushyagupta

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

Nalanda University was the International University founded in the reign of the Kumar Gupta-I in 450 AD. The great archaeologist Alexander Cunningham identified this site as Nalanda University in 1915-16.

25. Out of two statements below first is Assertion(A) and second is Reason (R), carefully read both statements.

Assertion (A) : Till the end of twelfth century Nalanda Mahavihara lost its glory

Reason (R) : State protection ceased to be available to Mahavihara.

With respect to the above-mentioned two statements, which of the following is true?

- (a) (A) and (R) both are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) (A) and (R) both are true, and (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)